

Fourth Suit Forcing New Minor Forcing Help Suit Game Try

FSF : Suppose the partnership has already mentioned three suits, and the player who is next to bid wants to make a forcing bid but has no bid that is really descriptive of his hand. He just bids the fourth suit (whether he has it or not). This asks partner to further describe her hand.

NMF : Similar to FSF, this is Responder's second bid after she makes a suit response to partner's suit opening and Opener then bids Notrump. Bidding a previously unbid (New) minor suit asks for further description.

HSGT : When the bidding starts 1Major - 2Major, Opener can invite to game by bidding 3Major. A more descriptive invitation is to bid a different suit; this is also an invitation to game but asks partner to pay particular attention to whether he can "Help" in that suit.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these three conventions.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣K

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♠2

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♦J

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♠3

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 9 7 5

♥ 8 2

♦ Q 7

♣ Q J 4 3

♠ 8 4

♥ A K 9 4 3

♦ A J 9 6

♣ 7 5



♠ 2

♥ 10 7 6

♦ 10 8 5 3 2

♣ A K 8 6

♠ A Q J 6 3

♥ Q J 5

♦ K 4

♣ 10 9 2

SOUTH should not use Fourth Suit Forcing to see if NORTH holds three ♠s because that information is irrelevant.

SOUTH already knows there is an 8-card ♥ fit and enough points to be in game so he bids it.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♦

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♣K

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 3
♥ 7 6 4 2
♦ K 10 8 2
♣ Q 5

♠ 10 4

♥ A Q 8

♦ Q 9 7 5

♣ 10 8 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K J 8 6

♥ J 5 3

♦ 3

♣ A K 6 3

♠ 7 5 2

♥ K 10 9

♦ A J 6 4

♣ J 9 7

EAST thinks there might be game if WEST can help with the three ♥ losers. So he bids 3♥ as a Help Suit Game Try.

WEST cannot provide any help at all, so quickly signs off in 3♠ which EAST passes.

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

2♠

Pass

3♥

Pass

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by East

Lead: ♠2

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 4
♥ A 7 6 5 4
♦ J 10 2
♣ A 7 3

♠ K 9 5

♥ K J 2

♦ A 9 6 3

♣ Q 6 4



♠ Q 7 3

♥ 10 8

♦ Q 8 5

♣ K J 10 9 2

♠ A J 8 6 2

♥ Q 9 3

♦ K 7 4

♣ 8 5

SOUTH bids 2♣ as New Minor Forcing, hoping NORTH will show three ♠s.

NORTH does show three ♠s, but also shows a minimum hand so South passes.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1♦	Pass	1♠
Pass	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠		
All Pass			
2♠ by South			
Lead: ♦J			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 9 5
♥ 10 4
♦ K Q 7 4
♣ K J 6 3

♠ Q 8 6 3

♥ 9 8 7

♦ A 10 6 3 2

♣ 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 10 7
♥ A K 6 5 2
♦ J 9 8
♣ Q 5

♠ J 4 2

♥ Q J 3

♦ 5

♣ A 10 9 8 7 4

EAST wants to be in game but doesn't know which one. If WEST holds three ♥s she would prefer 4♥, otherwise she would try 3NT. EAST bids 2♠, Fourth Suit Forcing.

WEST denies three ♥s but confirms a ♠ honor by bidding 2NT, so EAST bids the game in Notrump.

West	North	East	South
1♦	Pass	1♥	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♠3			